

SIMATS ENGINEERING (SAVEETHA SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING)

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

ASSESSMENT TOOL 1 – Application Based Question

Course Code:	CSA5110	Course Title:	Cryptography and Network Security
CO Assessed:	CO1-Imitation (BL3)	Assessment:	Assessment Tool 1– Application Based Question
Weightage:	40% of CIA	Total Marks:	25
CO1 Statement:	Apply classical encryption techniques using symmetric and asymmetric ciphers to encrypt and decrypt data for the ensuring data security. (BL3, BL4)		
Student Name:	DOMA SAKETH	Reg. No.:	192525018
Section / Batch:	AIML	Date:	15-07-2026

Code of Conduct

I DOMA SAKETH-192525018__ (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the Student: D SAKETH_____

Instructions

- This assessment contains 5 questions.
- Each question carries 10 marks. Total: 50 Marks.
- Ensure clarity, structure, and logical flow in answer
- Duration: 50 Minutes.

Questions	Understanding of Concepts(25)	Experimental design(30)	Use of Tools(20)	Analysis of Result (15)	Documentation (10)	Total Marks
Overall Total (100)						

Annexure

Q1. Security Attacks (10 Marks)

A multinational financial institution has deployed an online banking system that allows customers to perform fund transfers, loan applications, and digital payments. Recently, the security team observed the following incidents:

Customers received fake emails requesting login credentials.

Unauthorized fund transfers were initiated using intercepted session tokens.

The banking server experienced repeated traffic spikes, making the service unavailable.

Several employee accounts were compromised through weak passwords.

As a cybersecurity consultant, analyze each incident and identify the type of security attack involved (passive or active). Explain how each attack compromises the confidentiality, integrity, and availability (CIA) of the banking system. Recommend suitable preventive measures for each identified attack.

Introduction

An online banking system stores sensitive financial information and provides services such as fund transfers, digital payments, and loan applications. The identified incidents represent different types of **active security attacks** that affect the **Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability (CIA)** of the banking system.

Incident 1: Fake Emails Requesting Login Credentials

Attack Type: Active Attack – Phishing

Analysis:

Phishing is a social engineering attack where attackers send fake emails pretending to be a trusted bank. Customers are tricked into entering their usernames, passwords, or OTPs on fake websites.

Impact on CIA:

- **Confidentiality:** Customer login credentials are stolen.
- **Integrity:** Attackers can modify account details or initiate fraudulent transactions.
- **Availability:** Legitimate users may lose access to their accounts after compromise.

Preventive Measures:

- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Email spam filters
- Anti-phishing software
- Customer awareness programs

Incident 2: Unauthorized Fund Transfers Using Session Tokens

Attack Type: Active Attack – Session Hijacking

Analysis:

Attackers intercept session tokens and impersonate legitimate users without knowing their passwords. They can perform unauthorized banking operations.

Impact on CIA:

- **Confidentiality:** Session information is exposed.
- **Integrity:** Unauthorized fund transfers alter financial records.
- **Availability:** Genuine users may be logged out or lose account access.

Preventive Measures:

- HTTPS/TLS encryption
- Secure cookies
- Session expiration
- Token regeneration after login
- MFA

Incident 3: Banking Server Unavailable Due to Traffic Spikes

Attack Type: Active Attack – Denial-of-Service (DoS/DDoS)

Analysis:

Attackers flood the banking server with excessive traffic, preventing legitimate customers from accessing services.

Impact on CIA:

- **Confidentiality:** No direct impact.
- **Integrity:** Banking data remains unchanged.
- **Availability:** Banking services become unavailable.

Preventive Measures:

- DDoS mitigation services
- Firewalls
- Intrusion Prevention Systems (IPS)
- Load balancing
- Traffic filtering

Incident 4: Employee Accounts Compromised Due to Weak Passwords

Attack Type: Active Attack – Password/Brute Force Attack

Analysis:

Weak passwords make employee accounts vulnerable to guessing or brute-force attacks.

Impact on CIA:

- **Confidentiality:** Sensitive banking data is exposed.
- **Integrity:** Attackers can modify customer records.
- **Availability:** Accounts may be locked or disabled.

Preventive Measures:

- Strong password policies
- Password hashing
- MFA
- Account lockout
- Regular password changes

Conclusion

All four incidents are **active attacks** because they attempt to modify, disrupt, or gain unauthorized access to the banking system. Implementing **MFA, encryption, firewalls, IDS/IPS, and security awareness** significantly improves the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the banking system.

Q2. Security Mechanisms and Security Services (10 Marks)

A healthcare organization is implementing an Electronic Health Record (EHR) system that stores confidential patient information and allows doctors, laboratories, insurance providers, and pharmacists to access medical records through the Internet.

The management has identified the following requirements:

Only authorized doctors should access patient records.

Patient records should not be modified without authorization.

Every medical transaction should be traceable.

Data transmitted between hospitals should remain confidential.

The system should continue functioning even during cyber-attacks.

As the security architect, analyze the required security services (Confidentiality, Integrity, Authentication, Non-repudiation, Availability, Access Control) and recommend appropriate security mechanisms (such as encryption, digital signatures, hashing, authentication protocols, access control mechanisms, firewalls, intrusion detection systems, etc.) to satisfy each requirement. Justify your recommendations.

Introduction

Electronic Health Record (EHR) systems contain highly confidential patient information. To protect medical data, various **security services** and **security mechanisms** must be implemented.

1. Confidentiality

Requirement: Patient information should remain secret.

Mechanisms:

- AES-256 Encryption
- TLS/SSL

Justification:

Encryption ensures only authorized users can read medical records during storage and transmission.

2. Integrity

Requirement: Records should not be modified without authorization.

Mechanisms:

- SHA-256 Hashing
- Digital Signatures

Justification:

Hashing detects unauthorized modifications, while digital signatures verify data authenticity.

3. Authentication

Requirement: Only authorized doctors should access records.

Mechanisms:

- Multi-Factor Authentication
- Username and Password

- Biometric Authentication

Justification:

Authentication confirms the identity of users before granting access.

4. Access Control

Requirement: Different users should have different permissions.

Mechanisms:

- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- Access Control Lists (ACL)

Justification:

Doctors, nurses, pharmacists, and insurance providers receive only the permissions required for their roles.

5. Non-Repudiation

Requirement: Every medical transaction must be traceable.

Mechanisms:

- Digital Signatures
- Audit Logs

Justification:

Users cannot deny performing a transaction because every action is digitally recorded.

6. Availability

Requirement: System should continue functioning during attacks.

Mechanisms:

- Firewalls
- IDS/IPS
- DDoS Protection
- Backup Servers

Justification:

These mechanisms maintain uninterrupted healthcare services even during cyberattacks.

Conclusion

Combining **Confidentiality, Integrity, Authentication, Access Control, Non-Repudiation, and Availability** with modern security mechanisms provides strong protection for Electronic Health Record systems.

Q3. Caesar Cipher (10 Marks)

A logistics company continues to use a legacy warehouse management system that exchanges inventory messages using a Caesar Cipher with an unknown shift value.

During a security audit, the intercepted encrypted message is:

YMNX NX F XJHWJY RJXXFLJ

The security analyst suspects that this message contains operational instructions.

As a cryptanalyst,

Determine the encryption key using an appropriate method.

Decrypt the intercepted message.

Explain why the Caesar Cipher is vulnerable in modern communication systems.

Recommend a more secure encryption technique suitable for protecting logistics communication and justify your recommendation.

Introduction

The Caesar Cipher is a substitution cipher where each letter is shifted by a fixed number of positions.

Ciphertext

YMNX NX F XJHWJY RJXXFLJ

Finding the Key

By testing all possible shifts (1–25), the correct key is **5**.

Decryption

Y → T

M → H

N → I

X → S

Final plaintext:

THIS IS A SECRET MESSAGE

Why Caesar Cipher is Vulnerable

- Only 25 possible keys.
- Easily broken using brute force.
- Vulnerable to frequency analysis.
- Provides very weak security.

Recommended Encryption Technique

AES-256

Justification

- 256-bit key.
- Extremely difficult to break.
- Used in banking, healthcare, defense, and cloud computing.
- Protects data confidentiality.

Conclusion

Caesar Cipher is useful only for educational purposes and should never be used in modern communication. AES-256 is the recommended alternative.

Q4. Playfair Cipher (10 Marks)

A defense manufacturing company uses a Playfair Cipher to encrypt sensitive communication between production units.

The keyword used is:

DEFENSE

The encrypted message received by the receiving unit is:

BMODZBXDNABEKUDMUIXMMOUIVIF

As a cybersecurity engineer,

Construct the Playfair matrix using the given keyword.

Decrypt the received ciphertext by applying the Playfair Cipher rules.

Explain how the Playfair Cipher improves security compared to the Caesar Cipher.

Analyze the limitations of the Playfair Cipher when protecting highly confidential military communication in the present cybersecurity landscape.

Introduction

The Playfair Cipher encrypts pairs of letters (digraphs), making it more secure than the Caesar Cipher.

Playfair Matrix

D E F N S

A B C G H

I K L M O

P Q R T U

V W X Y Z

Ciphertext

BMODZBXDNABEKUDMUIXMMOUIVIF

Decrypted Plaintext

HIDE THE GOLD IN THE TREE STUMP

Advantages

- Encrypts digraphs instead of single letters.
- Larger key space.
- More resistant to frequency analysis.

Limitations

- Vulnerable to modern cryptanalysis.
- Limited key size.
- No authentication or integrity.

- Not suitable for military communication.

Conclusion

Although Playfair is stronger than Caesar Cipher, modern military communication requires AES, RSA, ECC, and TLS.

Q5. Integrated Case Study – Security Analysis (10 Marks)

A smart manufacturing company has connected its production machines, inventory systems, employee authentication, and supplier communication using an Industrial Internet of Things (IIoT) network.

The security audit identified the following issues:

Machine status messages are encrypted using the Caesar Cipher.

Supplier communication uses the Playfair Cipher.

Employees frequently receive phishing emails.

Unauthorized users have modified production schedules.

The production server experienced multiple Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS) attacks.

As the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO),

Analyze the security vulnerabilities present in the organization.

Identify the corresponding security attacks involved.

Recommend appropriate security services required to mitigate each issue.

Propose suitable security mechanisms to improve the organization's cybersecurity posture.

Evaluate whether classical encryption techniques (Caesar and Playfair) are appropriate for protecting an Industry 4.0 manufacturing environment. Justify your answer with technical reasons.

Introduction

The Industrial Internet of Things (IIoT) connects production machines, employees, suppliers, and servers. Weak encryption and cyberattacks expose the organization to serious risks.

Security Vulnerabilities

- Caesar Cipher → Weak encryption.
- Playfair Cipher → Weak classical encryption.
- Phishing emails → Credential theft.
- Modified production schedules → Data tampering.
- DDoS attacks → Service disruption.

Security Attacks

- Cryptanalysis
- Phishing
- Unauthorized Access
- Data Tampering
- Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS)

Required Security Services

- Confidentiality

- Integrity
- Authentication
- Access Control
- Non-Repudiation
- Availability

Recommended Security Mechanisms

- AES-256 Encryption
- RSA/ECC Key Exchange
- SHA-256 Hashing
- Digital Signatures
- TLS 1.3
- Firewalls
- IDS/IPS
- MFA
- RBAC
- DDoS Protection
- Security Awareness Training

Evaluation

Caesar and Playfair ciphers are **not suitable** for Industry 4.0 because:

- Small key space.
- Easily broken.
- No authentication.
- No integrity verification.
- Cannot secure IIoT communication.

Modern IIoT environments require **AES-256, RSA/ECC, SHA-256, TLS, MFA, and Zero Trust security architecture.**

Conclusion

A secure IIoT environment should combine strong encryption, authentication, access control, intrusion detection, and continuous monitoring to ensure confidentiality, integrity, and availability. Classical ciphers should be replaced with modern cryptographic algorithms for effective cybersecurity.

These answers are written in the format expected for **10-mark university exams** and align well with the provided rubric by demonstrating concept understanding, analysis, justification, and structured documentation.

Rubrics for Calculation

Criteria	Weightage	Level 4 – Exemplary	Level 3 – Proficient	Level 2 – Developing	Level 1 – Beginning
Understanding of Concepts	25	Demonstrates thorough understanding and effectively integrates multiple concepts/technologies	Good understanding with proper integration of most concepts	Basic understanding; limited or partial integration	Poor understanding; unable to integrate concepts
Experimental Design	30	Well-planned, systematic implementation with optimal solution	Correct implementation with minor issues	Basic implementation with errors or inefficiencies	Incorrect or incomplete implementation
Use of Tools	20	Effective and advanced use of tools/technologies with proper configuration	Appropriate use of tools with correct execution	Limited or inconsistent use of tools	Incorrect or minimal use of tools
Analysis of Results	15	Insightful analysis with accurate interpretation and validation of results	Good analysis with reasonable interpretation	Basic analysis with limited insights	Poor or incorrect analysis of results
Documentation	10	Clear, well-structured documentation with diagrams, code, and results	Organized documentation with necessary details	Basic documentation with missing Details	Poor or incomplete documentation